Somerset LANGUAGE CENTRE

SOMERSET LANGUAGE CENTRE · B2-LEVEL EXAM PRACTICE · CAMBRIDGE FORMAT

# Listening — Audioscript

**Candidate Name**

**Candidate Number**

**Centre**

**Date**

## TIME ALLOWED

for teacher use

## INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- Read each script aloud twice, at a natural exam pace, with a short pause between the two readings.
- Do not show this document to students.

## INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

| PART | QUESTIONS |
|---|---|
| Part 1 | 8 extracts |
| Part 2 | 1 monologue |
| Part 3 | 5 speakers |
| Part 4 | 1 interview |

## TEACHER COPY — CONFIDENTIAL

Contains answers and/or the listening scripts. Do not give this copy to students.

## Part 1 script

**EXTRACT 1** **KEY: A**

“I finally got round to doing that pottery course I'd been talking about for years — my sister actually bought me the voucher for my birthday, otherwise I probably never would have signed up. I was terrible at first, everything kept collapsing on the wheel, but by the third session I'd made something I was proud of. I'm already looking at booking the next level up.”

**EXTRACT 2** **KEY: B**

“We'd been looking for a new flat for months, and I was starting to lose hope — everything in our price range needed so much work. Then a colleague mentioned a place near hers that had just come onto the market. We went to see it that same evening and put in an offer the next morning.”

**EXTRACT 3** **KEY: B**

“Everyone else in my class was really excited about the school trip, but I'd been to that museum loads of times with my parents, so I wasn't that bothered. It turned out there was a whole new exhibition about space travel, though, and I ended up being the one dragging my friends around wanting to see everything.”

**EXTRACT 4** **KEY: C**

“I switched careers about two years ago, from marketing into teaching, and people still ask if I regret the pay cut. I don't — I reached a point where doing something useful mattered more to me than the salary. It wasn't an easy decision at the time, and my first year in the classroom was genuinely exhausting. But I wouldn't go back.”

**EXTRACT 5** **KEY: A**

“I twisted my ankle playing five-a-side about six weeks ago, and I was convinced I'd be back on the pitch within a fortnight. The physio had other ideas, though — she was quite blunt about it, telling me straight that rushing it would only make things worse in the long run. I'm still doing the exercises she gave me every single day, even though I'm fed up with them.”

**EXTRACT 6** **KEY: C**

“I've been trying to learn Portuguese for about a year now, mostly using an app on my phone during my commute. It's fine for building up vocabulary, but I noticed recently that I still freeze up completely the moment I try to have an actual conversation with someone. So I've just signed up for a weekly class with real people instead.”

**EXTRACT 7** **KEY: C**

“A friend recommended this new place in town, and I went in with fairly high expectations after everything she'd said. The food itself was excellent, genuinely some of the best I've had this year, but the service was so slow that we ended up sitting there for nearly three hours for what should have been a quick dinner. I'd still go back, but I'd book much earlier in the evening next time.”

**EXTRACT 8** **KEY: B**

“I started volunteering at the animal shelter almost by accident — a friend cancelled on me one Saturday and I ended up going along to what was supposed to be her shift instead of mine. That was over a year ago now, and I still go every single week. What surprised me most wasn't how much I enjoyed working with the animals, which I expected, but how much I've got to know the other volunteers there.”

## Part 2 script

### “WELCOME TO RIVERSIDE PHOTOGRAPHY CLUB”

Good evening everyone, and welcome to your first session with Riverside Photography Club. I'm Dan, and I'll be running most of the Tuesday evening sessions this term.

Just a bit of background: the club was founded in nineteen ninety-four, which actually makes us one of the oldest photography clubs in the whole region. We meet here at the community centre every week, except during the month of August, when we take a short summer break.

This term, we're focusing mainly on portrait photography, which I know a few of you specifically signed up for. We'll spend the first four weeks on lighting techniques before moving on to editing software in the second half of term.

If you haven't brought a camera tonight, don't worry — we do have a small number of cameras you can borrow for the evening, though I'd recommend bringing your own from next week if you can, even if it's just the one on your phone.

Membership for the full term costs thirty-five pounds, and that includes access to our online resource library as well as the two field trips we run each term. Our first field trip this term will be to Alderley Castle, which most of you will know is about twenty minutes from here by car.

One thing I do need from everyone tonight is a completed registration form — you'll find these on the table by the door, and I'll need them back to me by next Tuesday at the very latest, so please don't forget.

Finally, a quick note on our online group: we post weekly challenges and feedback there, and it's run through an app called Lensview rather than the usual social media platforms, mainly because it lets us share full-resolution images without them losing quality.

Right, let's get started with tonight's session, which is going to be all about understanding your camera's manual settings.

**Gap keys:**

- 9. The club was founded in ___ . — **1994 (nineteen ninety-four)**
- 10. The club does not meet during the month of ___ . — **August**
- 11. This term the club is focusing mainly on ___ photography. — **portrait**
- 12. The first four weeks of term will cover ___ . — **lighting techniques**
- 13. Students who don't bring a camera can ___ one for the evening. — **borrow**
- 14. Full membership for the term costs £ ___ . — **35**
- 15. The first field trip this term will be to ___ . — **Alderley Castle**

- 16. Everyone must hand in a completed ___ by next Tuesday. — **registration form**
- 17. The club's online group is run through an app called ___ . — **Lensview**
- 18. Tonight's session will focus on the camera's ___ settings. — **manual**

## Part 3 script

**SPEAKER 1 (Q19)** **KEY: C**

“I'd been made redundant twice in three years working for other people, and after the second time I just thought, right, I'm not doing this again — I'm going to work for myself from now on. It wasn't some brave lifelong dream, if I'm honest, it was more that I'd simply had enough of being let go through no fault of my own.”

**SPEAKER 2 (Q20)** **KEY: G**

“Everyone assumes the hard part is coming up with the idea, but for me it was genuinely the admin — registering the company, understanding the tax side of things, all of that. I'd never dealt with anything like it before and it took me twice as long as I expected just to get set up properly, let alone actually start trading.”

**SPEAKER 3 (Q21)** **KEY: H**

“My old university flatmate got in touch completely out of the blue, saying she'd had this idea for years and wanted to know if I fancied doing it with her. I said yes almost immediately, which looking back was a bit reckless, but three years on we still run the company together and it's honestly the best decision I've made.”

**SPEAKER 4 (Q22)** **KEY: A**

“I remember an aunt of mine, completely unprompted, offering to lend me the money to get started after hearing me talk about the idea at a family dinner. I hadn't asked her for anything, and I was genuinely shocked — it wasn't a huge amount, but it was enough to cover the first few months of rent on a small workspace.”

**SPEAKER 5 (Q23)** **KEY: B**

“I honestly thought I'd be able to run the business in the evenings and weekends alongside my normal job, at least for the first year. That turned out to be completely unrealistic — within a couple of months it had basically taken over every spare hour I had, and I ended up having to quit my job much sooner than I'd planned.”

## Part 4 script

**Interviewer:** Today I'm talking to wildlife photographer Claire Byrne about her new book, out this month. Claire, welcome.

**Claire:** Thanks for having me.

**Interviewer:** So, this book focuses on urban wildlife specifically — animals living in cities. What drew you to that, after years photographing more remote locations?

**Claire:** It was almost an accident. I was between bigger expeditions, stuck in London for a few months longer than planned, and I started noticing foxes on my evening walks. I thought, well, I've got the equipment sitting here doing nothing, I may as well use it. What started as something to fill the time completely took over — I ended up spending eighteen months on it in the end.

**Interviewer:** And was it harder or easier than photographing wildlife somewhere like the Amazon, say?

**Claire:** People always assume it must be easier, because you're not dealing with extreme heat or difficult terrain, but I'd say it was harder in its own way. Urban animals are very wary of people — more wary than animals that rarely see humans at all — so you actually need more patience, not less. I spent whole nights getting nothing usable at all.

**Interviewer:** Was there a particular image in the book that mattered most to you?

**Claire:** There's a shot of a fox family denning under an old railway bridge that I'm proud of, but it's not actually my favourite in the book. My favourite is a much quieter image — just a heron standing completely still on a car park roof at dawn. It's not dramatic at all, but something about it captures exactly what I was trying to say with the whole project.

**Interviewer:** Which is?

**Claire:** That wildlife isn't only out there somewhere far away that most of us will never see. It's already here, right alongside us, if we're willing to actually look for it.

**Interviewer:** Do you have advice for someone wanting to get into this kind of photography themselves?

**Claire:** Don't wait for the perfect equipment — that's probably my main advice. People always ask me about camera gear and think that's the barrier, but the biggest

difference is just spending time outdoors, learning the patterns of the animals near you. I made most of my best early images with equipment I'd now consider fairly basic.

**Interviewer:** And what's next for you?

**Claire:** I'm actually taking a proper break for the first time in years. It feels strange to admit that. After that, I have a vague idea about a similar project somewhere in Spain, maybe around Valencia — there's a lot of birdlife in the wetlands just south of the city that hasn't really been documented. But that's still just an idea at this stage, nothing confirmed.

**Interviewer:** Claire Byrne, thank you very much.

**Claire:** Thank you.